



◀ Graceful in defeat

Democratic politician Geraldine Ferraro concedes defeat in the US elections of 1984. She saw her candidacy as a sign that discrimination against women in politics was coming to an end.



BIOGRAPHY

MARGARET THATCHER

Born to a grocer and his wife in 1925, Margaret Thatcher went on to become leader of the UK's Conservative Party and later prime minister. During her three terms in power, she reshaped almost every aspect of British life, reforming many institutions, reducing the role of trade unions, and privatizing industries. One of the world's most influential leaders, her brand of conservatism inspired the ideology of many politicians while alienating others. She died in 2013.

In poorer parts of the world, particularly Asia, business-minded women began to benefit from microfinance, an idea kickstarted in 1983 by economics professor Muhammad Yunus. He lent \$27 to a group of rural Bangladeshi women making bamboo stools who, unable to purchase the raw materials they needed, were kept in a cycle of debt by the local traders they borrowed from. His Grameen Bank has since financed millions of female and male micro-entrepreneurs.

As the 1980s saw social and economic conservatism dominate on the political stage, women joined protest movements against such policies. In the UK, the Greenham Common Women's Peace Camp was set up at a Royal Air Force base in Berkshire in 1981 to protest



◀ Working it out

Jane Fonda's *Workout* was released on VHS tape in 1982 when most gyms were for men. It encouraged women to get fit at home and sold 17 million copies worldwide.

the British government's decision to store cruise missiles there. During the British miner's strike of 1984 to 1985, women also launched the Women Against Pit Closures campaign to raise awareness of the hardships miners' families faced. Women stood alongside men on the picket lines and promoted their cause at rallies in London and abroad. After the strikes ended, many women never returned to their former domestic lives. Many entered the world of work, continued to campaign for causes, or even opted for careers in politics.